Caleb H. Kelley, Ph.D.

Visiting Assistant Professor, Department of Spanish and Portuguese, Emory University

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Education

Ph.D. in Romance Languages 2024
The University of Alabama Tuscaloosa, AL

- **Dissertation:** *Sounding gay and straight in Seville: A variationist perspective on persona and syllable-final /s/ realization*
- **Advisor:** Dr. Erin O'Rourke

M.A. in Romance Languages 2017
The University of Alabama Tuscaloosa, AL

B.A. in Spanish 2013
University of Alabama at Birmingham Birmingham, AL

B.S. in Biology 2013
University of Alabama at Birmingham Birmingham, AL

Research Interests

My research examines how speakers use phonetic variation to construct socially meaningful personae and how listeners interpret those cues, with particular attention to the vocal performance and perception of sexual identity in Spanish. I combine acoustic analysis, perception experiments, and computational modeling within a sociophonetic, third-wave variationist framework.

***Keywords*:** sociophonetics; phonetics and phonology; language variation and change; language, gender, and sexuality; persona and indexicality; speech perception; Spanish and Hispanic linguistics; quantitative and computational methods

Academic Appointments

Visiting Assistant Professor 2024 – present
Department of Spanish and Portuguese, Emory University Atlanta, GA

Graduate Teaching Assistant/Instructor of Record 2015 – 2024
Department of Modern Languages and Classics, The University of Alabama Tuscaloosa, AL

Adjunct Instructor of Spanish 2021 – 2022
Department of English and World Languages, University of Montevallo Montevallo, AL

Teaching Experience

AT EMORY UNIVERSITY

Visiting Assistant Professor 2024 – present
Elementary and intermediate Spanish (SPAN 101, 102, 201, 202); SPAN 212: Introduction to Hispanic Texts and Contexts

- Design complete instructional units from learning objectives outward, producing lesson plans, instructor scripts, slide decks, handouts, and performance assessments aligned to ACTFL proficiency guidelines.
- Build and deliver Canvas course content and Integrated Performance Assessments across in-person, online, and blended sections.
- Authored a student-facing policy for responsible AI use built on a green, yellow, and red framework.
- Evaluate teaching through thematic analysis of course feedback and analysis of gradebook data in R, then turn the findings into course revisions.

AT THE UNIVERSITY OF ALABAMA

Graduate Instructor of Record 2015 – 2024

Elementary and intermediate Spanish (SP 101, 102, 103, 201, 202), including online sections; SP 353: Spanish Conversation; SP 356: Advanced Grammar and Composition

- As Spanish 102 Coordinator, coordinated curriculum, quality standards, and assessment design across 43 sections of introductory Spanish, supporting and training a large team of graduate instructors.
- Mentored and team-taught with new instructors across three years, modeling student-centered classroom practice.
- Partnered with Dr. Bryan Koronkiewicz to design SP 383: Linguistic Fundamentals of the Spanish Language, turning specialist material into teachable lessons and assessments.

AT UNIVERSITY OF MONTEVALLO

Adjunct Instructor 2021 – 2022

Elementary and intermediate Spanish (SPN 101, 102, 201)

Publications

MANUSCRIPTS UNDER REVIEW

Kelley, C. H. (under review). Prosodic persona construction across three Spanish varieties: Asymmetric vocal stereotypes in Sevilla, País Vasco, and Venezuela.

MANUSCRIPTS IN PREPARATION

Kelley, C. H. (in preparation). Vowel space and performed identity in male Sevillian speech.

Current Projects

Kelley, C. H. (in progress). Sociophonetic perception of sexual identity: Evidence from native and non-native Spanish speakers. [Matched-guise perception study; data collection Fall 2026.]

Kelley, C. H. (in progress). Supervised classification of sociophonetic identity markers in Sevillian Spanish persona production. [Random Forest and SVM classification of a persona-switching corpus.]

Presentations

INVITED TALKS

Kelley, C. H. (2026, March 11). *From Production to Perception: Designing a Sociophonetic Study*, Department of Modern Languages and Classics, The University of Alabama, Tuscaloosa, AL.

Kelley, C. H. (2020, November). *Foundations of Spanish Phonetics and Phonology*, Guest Lecture for SP 383: Linguistic Fundamentals of the Spanish Language, University of Alabama, Tuscaloosa, AL.

PEER-REVIEWED CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

Kelley, C. H. (2026). Modeling prosodic variation in Spanish gay and straight personae. *Southeastern Conference on Linguistics (SECOL) 2026*, Atlanta, GA. [accepted]

Kelley, C. H. (2024). Phonetic dimensions of gay-sounding speech in Spanish: Syllable-final /s/ variation and persona performance. *Linguistics Conference at the University of Georgia (LCUGA) 2024*, University of Georgia, Athens, GA.

Kelley, C. H. (2023). Analyzing the phonetic performance of male sexuality in Sevillian Spanish through remote data collection. *New Ways of Analyzing Variation (NWAV) 51*, Queens College, Flushing, NY.

Kelley, C. H. (2023). Analyzing the performance of male sexuality in Spanish through remote data collection and digital corpus analysis. *Congreso Internacional de Lingüística Digital (CILiDi) 2*, Universidad de Alicante, Alicante, Spain.

Kelley, C. H. (2023). Syllable-final /s/ and the sociolinguistic construction of personae in Spanish speakers. *OSU Congress on Hispanic and Lusophone Linguistics Symposium (OSUCHiLL) 27*, The Ohio State University, Columbus, OH.

Kelley, C. H. (2023). Using sociolinguistic personae to analyze phonetic variation among gay and non-gay Spanish speakers. *University of Alabama Languages Conference (UALC)*, The University of Alabama, Tuscaloosa, AL.

Kelley, C. H. (2022). A pilot study investigating sociophonetic variation among LGBTQ+ speakers in Peninsular Spanish. *University of Alabama Languages Conference (UALC)*, The University of Alabama, Tuscaloosa, AL.

Kelley, C. H. (2021). Sounding queer in Spain: A sociophonetic analysis of production and perception. *Lavender Languages & Linguistics 27*, California Institute of Integral Studies, San Francisco, CA [accepted 2020; conference postponed to 2021 due to COVID-19 pandemic].

Jacobson, S., & **Kelley, C. H.** (2020). Very? Much!: A corpus analysis of alternation between “muy” and “mucho” in Spanish. *10th International Workshop on Spanish Sociolinguistics*, Georgia Institute of Technology, Atlanta, GA [accepted; canceled due to COVID-19 pandemic].

Jacobson, S., & **Kelley, C. H.** (2017). “To be” or “to not be”: Attitudes and behaviors toward the split infinitive in English. *8th International Contrastive Linguistics Conference*, National and Kapodistrian University of Athens, Athens, Greece.

Kelley, C. H. (2016). The Madre María de San José (1656–1719) Project. *Digitorium: University of Alabama Digital Humanities Conference*, The University of Alabama, Tuscaloosa, AL.

Kelley, C. H. (2016). Null and overt subject pronouns in Madrid and Caracas with verbs of external activity: A corpus study. *Linguistics Conference at the University of Georgia (LCUGA) 3*, University of Georgia, Athens, GA.

PEER-REVIEWED POSTER PRESENTATIONS

Kelley, C. H. (2025). Prosodic identity performance in Spanish: A mixed-effects analysis of gay and straight vocal personae. *Hispanic Linguistics Symposium (HLS) 2025*, University of Arizona, Tucson, AZ.

Kelley, C. H. (2022). Performing sexual orientation in Spanish: A pilot study investigating persona and syllable-final /s/ realization. *10th Workshop on Spanish Sociolinguistics (WSS10)*, University of Georgia, Athens, GA.

Kelley, C. H. (2016). Null and overt subject pronouns in Madrid and Caracas with verbs of external activity: A corpus study. *Quantitative Methods in Linguistics Research Showcase*, The University of Alabama, Tuscaloosa, AL.

Funding

RESEARCH SUPPORT

Faculty research fund 2026 – 2027
Department of Spanish and Portuguese, Emory University

Research support awards (4) 2021 – 2024
UA Graduate School/Modern Languages and Classics

CONFERENCE TRAVEL

Conference funding and travel awards (6) 2017 – 2023
UA Graduate School/Modern Languages and Classics; UA Capstone International

EXTERNAL APPLICATIONS

Lewis and Clark Fund for Exploration and Field Research 2022, 2023
American Philosophical Society (not funded)

Service

TO THE PROFESSION

Linguistic Society of America Committee on LGBTQ+ [Z] Issues in Linguistics (COZIL) 2023 – 2024
Member

Abstract Reviewer 2017 – 2022
University of Alabama Languages Conference (UALC)

TO THE DEPARTMENT AND UNIVERSITY

Spanish 102 Coordinator 2020 – 2022
Spanish Basic Language Program, Department of Modern Languages and Classics, UA (43 sections)

Graduate Student Representative 2021 – 2022
Department of Modern Languages and Classics, UA

LengUA Lab Graduate Student Co-director 2020 – 2021
UA (Linguistics research group)

LengUA Lab Member 2016 – 2024
UA

CONFERENCE ORGANIZATION

Committee Member, UALC 2021 – 2022
University of Alabama Languages Conference

IT Committee Member, UALC 2020 – 2021
University of Alabama Languages Conference

Registration Chair, UALC 2018 – 2019
University of Alabama Languages Conference

Vice President/Program Chair, UALC 2017 – 2018
University of Alabama Languages Conference

STUDENT ORGANIZATIONS AND COMMUNITY OUTREACH

Vice President, La Última Letra 2018 – 2019
UA

Secretary, La Última Letra 2016 – 2017
UA

Event Judge, Convención de la Federación de los Círculos de Español de Alabama 2015 – 2020

MENTORING

Jim Moore Spring 2021
Team teaching assistant and mentee for SP 102 course, UA

Katie Cauley Fall 2020
Team teaching assistant and mentee for SP 102 course, UA

Jordyn Battistelli Fall 2019
Team teaching assistant and mentee for SP 201 course, UA

Professional Development

Dissertation Summer Writing Challenge, The University of Alabama. Summer 2022.

David Bauer Grant Writing Workshop, The University of Alabama. Fall 2021.

Writing for Academic Publication, Advanced Seminar (CSE 690), The University of Alabama. Spring 2019.

Online Teaching Certification, The University of Alabama. 2016 – 2024.

Memberships, Languages, & Technical Skills

Memberships	Linguistic Society of America (LSA) • Acoustical Society of America (ASA) • Alabama World Languages Association (AWLA) • Sigma Delta Pi (Omicron Mu Chapter)
Languages	English (native) • Spanish (near-native) • French (intermediate)
Programming	R • Python • Praat scripting • Bash/Unix • LaTeX • HTML/CSS • Git/GitHub
Software	Microsoft Office 365 • Adobe Creative Suite • Qualtrics • RStudio • SPSS • Audacity • Montreal Forced Aligner • ELAN • Zotero • EndNote
Platforms	Canvas • Blackboard • LingroLearning • VHL Central • Google Drive • Box

References available upon request.